DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

What survives the mixture — nullification, the ark, and the words that outlast both.

Sunday, 11 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 6:9-6:22) · Daf Bekhorot 23

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

The ashes that purify and contaminate

Jev score: 0.56 — Jev scored 10 linked sources on whether each illuminates the daf in a non-obvious way; Numbers 19 — the red-heifer chapter behind the daf's Para 9:7 proof-text — scored 0.56, the highest.

The daf's sharpest stress-test of the 'revival' principle comes from an unlikely mixture: the ashes of the red heifer intermingled with ordinary ash (Para 9:7). Abaye's objection turns on a paradox Numbers 19 builds into the rite itself — the purifier contaminates everyone who prepares it. If nullified impurity merely sleeps, he argues, then even where the majority rules the mixture pure for contact, the red-heifer ash should still transmit impurity through carrying.

Reading Numbers 19 alongside the sugya shows why the daf keeps returning to this case: it is the one mixture where the Torah itself legislated the contradiction. The chapter's ritual logic — the same ashes that cleanse the corpse-impure defile the priest — is the scriptural ancestor of the daf's question: can something be simultaneously nullified and present? The sugya's answer, via Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina, splits the difference exactly where the chapter does: pure for contact, impure for carrying.

PARSHA · NOACH

When is a world past salvage?

Jev score: 0.42 — Jev scored 6 candidate daf–parsha connections for groundedness in the two texts; the decay-boundary parallel scored 0.42, the best of a weak field.

The daf's second movement asks when decay itself ends impurity: bar Padda says when the carcass is no longer fit for a ger toshav, Rabbi Yochanan when it is no longer fit for a dog. It is a jurisprudence of the point of no return. Noach opens with the divine version of that ruling — God surveys the generation, finds 'all flesh had corrupted its ways,' and declares the world fit only for destruction. The flood is what happens when the Judge concludes nothing salvageable remains.

That is a tonal echo, not a textual one, and Jev scored it accordingly (0.42). The daf is arguing about carcasses and brine; the parsha is not thinking about nullification at all. But the structural rhyme is real: both texts need a rule for when to stop asking whether something can be recovered — and both answer by watching what it is still fit for.

Rejected by Jev: the ark as 'anti-bitul' (0.29), the revival principle at cosmic scale (0.23), the presumption-of-corruption parallel (0.35), the seven-pairs majority (0.21), water as nullifier of last resort (0.29).

NEWS CHECK

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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No strong resonance this week

Jev score: 0.31 — Jev scored 8 proposed news links with strict instructions; none cleared 0.35.

The closest the week came was Gaza: a ceasefire meant to nullify a war, now in its second year, with 1,400 Palestinians killed by Israeli fire since the truce and both sides accusing the other of rearming — the daf's 'revival' question (does the nullified thing wake up?) wearing modern dress. Jev gave it 0.31: suggestive, but the mechanism is politics, not halakhah, and the resemblance dissolves on inspection.

Everything else shared no more than a word with the daf. A Nobel Prize that singles out one figure, bombers withdrawn from a threatened base, an El Niño warning for 347 million children — none of them turns on whether a minority dissolves into a majority or wakes up again. An honest week: the daf stands alone.

MAAGARIM · BITUL

ביטול: 656 attestations, from neglected study to nullified impurity to a curl of the lip

The Historical Dictionary's 569 citations for ביטול open with a surprise: the word's earliest layer is not the halakhic 'nullification' of our daf at all, but idleness — 'מפני ביטול בית המדרש,' the Mishnah's reason for moving straw on Shabbat (Shabbat 16:1): lest the study hall sit empty. ביטול first means making nothing of one's time. The technical sense the sugya lives in — a minority substance made nothing inside a majority — is a later rabbinic specialization of that same emptying.

And then the modern turn. In Yitzhak Shami's 1927 'נקמת האבות' the word has curled into contempt: 'חיוך של בטול ולעג,' a smile of nullification and scorn; Bialik in 1934 writes 'גמור דרך בטול,' a gesture of utter dismissal. From emptying the study hall, to emptying a forbidden substance of its identity, to emptying one's face of respect — ביטול is always the art of making something nothing. What changes across eighteen centuries is only what gets made nothing.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.

929 · I KINGS 4 (CH. 291)

The kingdom at its zenith — an administration in lists

I Kings 4 is the Bible's most bureaucratic chapter, and that is the point. After three chapters of succession struggle — Adonijah, Joab, Shimei — Solomon's kingdom is finally, in the chapter's thrice-repeated phrase, 'over all Israel.' The commentators hear the relief in the

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repetition. Rashi reads verse 1 psychologically: once they saw his wisdom, 'they all rejoiced in his kingship.' Radak adds the historical contrast: unlike David, who began by ruling only Judah, no one questioned Solomon's throne, 'since they saw divine wisdom within him to do justice.' Malbim counts three converging causes — his father's appointment, the elimination of his enemies, and the wisdom God gave him — and only the third made the people love him.

The heart of the chapter is two lists: the court officials (vv. 2–6) and the twelve district governors (vv. 7–19). Radak notices what the list is really doing: the twelve officers were not assigned tribe by tribe but by surveyed land portions, 'and they collected the tax equally' — an administrative rationality, taxation by district rather than by kinship, that quietly dissolves the old tribal map. Rashi glosses their function with characteristic concreteness: 'וכלכלו את המלך' means all his meals, the horses' fodder, every expense. Ralbag stresses the system's fairness: each governor knew his district and his month, 'so that all of them would sustain him all year.'

The chapter's final verse is its thesis statement: 'Judah and Israel were many, as the sand upon the sea, eating and drinking and rejoicing.' Radak reads the simile as blessing made visible — fruitful wombs, herds, and fields, 'and they had no fear of an enemy.' Malbim does the arithmetic of abundance: by Abarbanel's count sixty thousand ate at the king's table daily, yet it was no burden 'on a people numerous as the sand, who lacked no good thing.' The eating and drinking is not decadence; it is the covenant meal of a kingdom at rest.

Structurally the chapter is a mirror held up to David's reign. David's story is movement — flight, battle, conquest. Solomon's is administration: scribes, a recorder, the army commander, the priests, the governors, the provision lists. The literary device is the list itself, and its repeated 'over all Israel' is doing theological work: the unity David fought for, Solomon files. That is also the chapter's poignancy in the book's arc. This is the last moment the kingdom is whole and unthreatened — the very next chapter turns to the Temple's construction, and within a generation the twelve districts will become the fault lines of secession.

One small gem: the officers 'not mentioned by their own names but by their fathers' names' (v. 8ff). Radak explains they were better known by their fathers' names, so Scripture 'did not bother' with their own. Even at the height of royal centralization, identity still ran through the father — the bureaucracy had not yet flattened the person.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 9:9-10

The hive and the house: which way does impurity travel?

Oholot 9:9

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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הָיְתָה מְמַלְּאָה אֶת כָּל הַבַּיִת וְאֵין בֵּינָהּ לְבֵין הַקּוֹרוֹת פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה בְתוֹכָהּ, הַבַּיִת טָמֵא. טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת, מַה שֶּׁבְּתוֹכָהּ טָהוֹר, שֶׁדֶּרֶךְ טֻמְאָה לָצֵאת וְאֵין דַּרְכָּהּ לְהִכָּנֵס, בֵּין עוֹמֶדֶת בֵּין מֻטָּה עַל צִדָּהּ, בֵּין אַחַת בֵּין שְׁתָּיִם:

[In the case when the hive] was entirely within the house and there is not a space of a handbreadth between it and the roof beams, if there is uncleanness within [the hive], the house becomes unclean. But if there is uncleanness in the house, what is within [the hive] remains clean, for the manner of the uncleanness is to go out and not to go in. [Whether [the hive] is standing upright, or lying on its side, whether there is one [hive] or two.

Rambam: The hive sits inside the house with its mouth toward the roof, less than a handbreadth from the beams — the measure that transmits impurity. One hive or two stacked, it makes no difference (as the Tosefta explains): impurity inside the hive defiles the house, but impurity in the house leaves the hive's contents pure, upright or on its side.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnah 9 opens a new sub-unit — the hive's various positions, no longer in the doorway. The 'less than a handbreadth' clause is actually halakhically inert here (even a much higher opening would give the same ruling); it drifted in from the following mishnah where height is decisive. The ruling's logic: impurity has nowhere to go but into the house — while impurity in the house will not enter the vessel, 'for it is the way of impurity to exit, and not its way to enter.'

Oholot 9:10

הָיְתָה עוֹמֶדֶת בְּתוֹךְ הַפֶּתַח וְאֵין בֵּינָהּ לְבֵין הַמַּשְׁקוֹף פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה בְתוֹכָהּ, הַבַּיִת טָהוֹר. טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת, מַה שֶּׁבְּתוֹכָהּ טָמֵא, שֶׁדֶּרֶךְ הַטֻּמְאָה לָצֵאת וְאֵין דַּרְכָּהּ לְהִכָּנֵס:

If it was standing upright in the doorway and there was not a space of one handbreadth between it and the lintel: If there is uncleanness within it, the house remains clean. But if there is uncleanness in the house, what is within [the hive] becomes unclean, for the manner of the uncleanness is to go out and not to go in.

Rambam: 'Lintel' (שקוף) is the upper doorpost Scripture calls משקוף. Impurity inside the hive beneath the lintel, with less than a handbreadth between, exits the house — the lintel's underside is no tent. But impurity in the house defiles the hive's contents, since impurity leaves the house through its doorway and strikes what is in the hive: 'for it is the way of impurity to exit.'

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: A doorway's roof (the upper lintel) forms no tent, so impurity there counts as sitting in the doorway itself — and impurity in a doorway naturally exits outward rather than entering the room (contrast the wall-cases of ch. 6). Textual note: all witnesses read 'בתוכה' where the sense demands 'בתוכו,' and the printed text is corrupt — the house is obviously impure; the question is the hive's interior.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT YIBBUM VACHALITZAH 7

Two sisters, one yavam: systematizing the impossible case

Halachah 1

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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שְׁנַיִם מִן הָאַחִין נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת וּמֵתוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם וְלֹא נוֹדַע אֵי זֶה מֵהֶם מֵת רִאשׁוֹן. הוֹאִיל וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לְיַבֵּם שְׁתֵּיהֶן וַהֲרֵי זִקָּה נָפְלָה עַל שְׁתֵּיהֶן חוֹלְצוֹת וְלֹא מִתְיַבְּמוֹת. וַאֲפִלּוּ הָיְתָה אַחַת מֵהֶן אֲסוּרָה עַל הַיָּבָם מִשּׁוּם שְׁנִיָּה אוֹ מֵחֲמַת מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה אוֹ מֵחֲמַת מִצְוַת לָאוִין הֲרֵי אֵלּוּ חוֹלְצוֹת וְלֹא מִתְיַבְּמוֹת. אֲבָל אִם הָיְתָה אַחַת מֵהֶן עֶרְוָה עָלָיו כְּגוֹן שֶׁהָיְתָה אֵם אִשְׁתּוֹ אוֹ בִּתָּהּ. הֲרֵי אֲחוֹתָהּ מֻתֶּרֶת לוֹ וְרָצָה חוֹלֵץ רָצָה מְיַבֵּם. שֶׁהֲרֵי לֹא נָפְלָה זִקָּתוֹ עַל שְׁתֵּיהֶן, שֶׁאֵין זִקָּה עַל הָעֶרְוָה:

When two brothers were married to two sisters, [the brothers] both died, and it is impossible to know who died first, [a third brother who remains alive] may not perform yibbum with both of them. Since they are both obligated to him, they both must perform chalitzah and not yibbum. [The above ruling applies even] when one [of the yevamot] was forbidden to the yavam as a sh'niyah, or because of a positive commandment or a negative commandment. If, however, one [of the yevamot] was forbidden to the yavam as an ervah - e.g., she was his wife's mother or daughter - the sister is permitted [to the yavam]; he may perform either yibbum or chalitzah, as he desires. For both of the sisters were not obligated to him, since an ervah is not bound by this obligation.

Halachah 2

הָיְתָה אַחַת מֵהֶן אֲסוּרָה עַל יָבָם זֶה מִשּׁוּם עֶרְוָה. וְהָאַחֶרֶת אֲסוּרָה עַל הַיָּבָם הַשֵּׁנִי מִשּׁוּם עֶרְוָה. הָאֲסוּרָה לָזֶה מֻתֶּרֶת לְאָחִיו וְהָאֲסוּרָה לָזֶה מֻתֶּרֶת לְאָחִיו. שֶׁהֲרֵי נָפְלָה זִקַּת כָּל אֶחָד מֵהֶן עַל הַמֻּתֶּרֶת לוֹ בִּלְבַד. וְרָצָה חוֹלֵץ רָצָה מְיַבֵּם לְזוֹ הַמֻּתֶּרֶת לוֹ:

When in the above situation there were four brothers,] and one [of the yevamot] was forbidden to one of the yevamim as an ervah, and the other yevamah was forbidden to the other yavam as an ervah, [the yevamah] who is forbidden to one [yavam] is permitted to his brother, and [the yevamah] who is forbidden to the other [yavam] is permitted to his brother. For [in both instances] only [the yevamah] who is permitted to him is obligated [to each brother]. [Each one] may perform either yibbum or chalitzah with [the yevamah] permitted to him, as he desires.

Halachah 3

מֵת אֶחָד מִן הָאַחִין וְנָפְלָה אִשְׁתּוֹ לְיִבּוּם וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵת שֵׁנִי וְנָפְלָה אִשְׁתּוֹ לְיִבּוּם שֶׁהִיא אֲחוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנָה וַהֲרֵי שְׁתֵּיהֶן קַיָּמוֹת. שְׁתֵּיהֶן חוֹלְצוֹת וְלֹא מִתְיַבְּמוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

[In the above situation,] if one of the brothers died [and his identity was known], and his wife became obligated to perform yibbum, and then the other brother died, his wife - the sister of the first wife - became obligated to perform yibbum; [as long as] both remain alive, they both must perform chalitzah and not yibbum, as we have explained.

Halachah 4

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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מֻתָּה הָאַחֲרוֹנָה חֲזָרָה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה לְהֶתֵּרָהּ וְחוֹלֶצֶת אוֹ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. מֻתָּה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה הֲרֵי אַחֲרוֹנָה בְּאִסּוּרָהּ עוֹמֶדֶת וְחוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. שֶׁהֲרֵי לֹא הָיְתָה רְאוּיָה לְיִבּוּם בְּשָׁעַת נְפִילָתָהּ. וְכֵן אִם קִדַּם אֶחָד מִן הָאַחִין וְחָלַץ לָאַחֲרוֹנָה הֶתֵּרָה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה לִשְׁאָר הָאַחִין שֶׁהֲרֵי הַזִּקָּה שֶׁאָסְרָה אוֹתָהּ הֵסִירָהּ אָחִיו בַּחֲלִיצָתוֹ׃

If [the wife of] the second [brother] dies, the [wife of the] first becomes permitted again. She may perform either chalitzah or yibbum. If [the wife of] the first [brother] dies, the [wife of the] second remains forbidden. She must perform chalitzah and may not perform yibbum. [The rationale is that she was not fit to perform yibbum at the time she came before [her yavam]. Similarly, if one of the brothers performed chalitzah with the [wife of the] second [brother] first, the [wife of the] first becomes permitted to the other brothers. For the obligation that caused her to become forbidden was removed by his brother by performing chalitzah.

Halachah 5

וְכֵן אִם הָיְתָה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה עֶרְוָה עַל אֶחָד מִן הָאַחִין וְקִדַּם וְיִבֵּם אֶת הָאַחֲרוֹנָה שֶׁהִיא מֻתֶּרֶת לוֹ הֻתְּרָה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה לִשְׁאָר הָאַחִין שֶׁהֲרֵי הָאַחֲרוֹנָה שֶׁאָסְרָה אוֹתָהּ עֲלֵיהֶן נִתְיַבְּמָה לְמֻתָּר לָהּ. אֲבָל אִם הָיְתָה הָאַחֲרוֹנָה הִיא שֶׁאֲסוּרָה עַל אֶחָד מֵהֶן בִּלְבַד מִשּׁוּם עֶרְוָה הֲרֵי הוּא מְיַבֵּם לָרִאשׁוֹנָה וּשְׁאָר הָאַחִין אֲסוּרִין בִּשְׁתֵּיהֶן וְחוֹלְצִין וְלֹא מְיַבְּמִין כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ. וְאִם קָדְמוּ וְכָנְסוּ כָּל אֶחָד אַחַת מִן הָאֲחָיוֹת מוֹצִיאִין אוֹתָן מֵהֶן׃

Similarly, if [the wife of] the first [brother] was forbidden to one of the brothers as an ervah, and he performed yibbum with [the wife of] the second [brother] who was permitted to him, the [wife of the] first becomes permitted to the other brothers. For the woman who caused her to be forbidden to them performed yibbum with a brother to whom she was permitted. If, however, [the wife of] the second [brother] was forbidden to one of the brothers as an ervah, he should perform yibbum with [the wife of] the first [brother], but the other brothers are forbidden to perform yibbum with both of them. They must perform chalitzah instead, as we have explained. If [in the situation mentioned in the final clause of Halachah 3] each one of the brothers marries one of the sisters [without asking Rabbinical guidance first], they must be forced to separate.

Halachah 6

שְׁלֹשָׁה אַחִין שְׁנַיִם מֵהֶן נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת. מֵת אֶחָד מִבַּעֲלֵי אֲחָיוֹת וְעָשָׂה הַשְּׁלִישִׁי בְּיִבְמְתּוֹ מַאֲמָר וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵת בַּעַל אֲחוֹת הַשְּׁנִיָּה וְנָפְלָה הָאָחוֹת הַשְּׁנִיָּה לִפְנֵי הָאָח הַשְּׁלִישִׁי. הֲרֵי זֶה נוֹתֵן גֵּט לְבַעֲלַת הַמַּאֲמָר וְחוֹלֵץ לָהּ וְחוֹלֵץ לָאָחוֹת הָאַחֲרוֹנָה כְּדֵי לְהַתִּירָן לָזָר׃

[Our Sages delivered these rulings in the following situation:] There were three brothers. Two were married to two sisters. One of the brothers married to the sisters died [childless].

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

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The third [brother] gave a ma'amar to his yevamah, and then the husband of the second sister died, and the second sister also became obligated to the third brother. The third brother should divorce with a get [the sister] to whom he gave a ma'amar, and perform chalitzah with her. And he should perform chalitzah with the other sister, to enable her to marry another man.

Halachah 7

מֵת זֶה שֶׁעָשָׂה הַמַּאֲמָר וְהָיְתָה לוֹ אִשָּׁה אַחֶרֶת וְנָפְלוּ שְׁתֵּיהֶן לִפְנֵי בַּעַל הָאָחוֹת. בַּעֲלַת הַמַּאֲמָר פְּטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם שֶׁהֲרֵי הִיא אֲחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ. וְהָאִשָּׁה הָאַחֶרֶת חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. שֶׁאֵין הַמַּאֲמָר קוֹנֶה קִנְיָן גָּמוּר עַד שֶׁיִּפְטֹר אֶת הַצָּרָה:

[In the above situation,] if the brother who gave the ma'amar [to the first brother's wife] died [childless], and he had another wife, both she and [the wife of the first brother] fall before [the brother] married to the sister of [the wife of the first brother]. The woman who was given the ma'amar is free from the obligations of chalitzah and yibbum, for she is the sister of [her yavam's] wife. The other woman should perform chalitzah and not yibbum, because the ma'amar does not fully acquire a woman [as a wife] to the extent that another wife would be freed of the obligations [of yibbum].

Halachah 8

אֶחָד מִן הַיְבָמִין שֶׁקִּדֵּשׁ אֲחוֹת יְבִמְתּוֹ אוֹמְרִין לוֹ הַמְתֵּן וְאַל תִּגָּרְשֶׁנָּה וְאַל תִּשָּׂאֶנָּה עַד שֶׁיְּיַבֵּם אָחִיךָ אוֹ יַחֲלֹץ לִיבָמָה זוֹ הַזְּקוּקָה לְכֻלְּכֶם. חָלַץ לָהּ אָחִיו אוֹ יִבְּמָהּ אוֹ שֶׁמֵּתָה הַיְבָמָה הֲרֵי זֶה יְכוֹנֵס אֲרוּסָתוֹ. מֵתוּ אֶחָיו כֻּלָּם מוֹצִיא אֶת אֲרוּסָתוֹ בְּגֵט וִיבִמְתּוֹ בַּחֲלִיצָה. וְאִם מֵתָה אֲרוּסָתוֹ בֵּין שֶׁמֵּתָה קֹדֶם מִיתַת הָאַחִין בֵּין שֶׁמֵּתָה לְאַחַר מִיתַת הָאַחִין חֲזָרָה הַיְבָמָה לְהֶתֵּרָהּ וְרָצָה חוֹלֵץ רָצָה מְיַבֵּם:

When a brother consecrates the sister of his yevamah, we tell him: "Wait; do not divorce her and do not marry her until your brother performs yibbum or chalitzah with the woman who is under obligation." If his brother performs yibbum or chalitzah with the yevamah, or if she dies, the brother may marry the woman he has consecrated. If all his brothers die, he must divorce with a get the woman he has consecrated, and perform chalitzah with his yevamah. If the woman he has consecrated died, regardless of whether she died before the brothers died or after the brothers died, the yevamah becomes permitted. He may perform either yibbum or chalitzah.

Halachah 9

שְׁלֹשָׁה אַחִין שְׁנַיִם מֵהֶן נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת וְיֵשׁ לְכָל אַחַת מִשְּׁתֵּיהֶן צָרָה. וּמֵתוּ הַנְּשׂוּאִין אֶת הָאֲחָיוֹת וְנָפְלוּ הָאֲחָיוֹת וְצָרוֹתֵיהֶן לִפְנֵי יָבָם. אִם חָלַץ לַצָּרוֹת נִפְטְרוּ הָאֲחָיוֹת. אֲבָל אִם חָלַץ לָאֲחָיוֹת לֹא נִפְטְרוּ צָרוֹתֵיהֶן עַד שֶׁיְּחַלְּצוּ הַצָּרוֹת. מִפְּנֵי שֶׁחֲלִיצַת אֲחָיוֹת חֲלִיצָה שֶׁאֵינָהּ מְעֻלָּה. וַחֲלִיצָה

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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שֶׁאֵינָהּ מְעֻלָּה אֵינָהּ פּוֹטֶרֶת אֶת הַצָּרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ׃

[The above laws become even more complicated if the brothers have more than one wife. For example,] there were three brothers. Two were married to two sisters, and each also had another wife. [The brothers] married to the sisters died [childless], and the sisters and the other wives fell before the yavam. If he performs chalitzah with the other wives, the sisters are also freed of their obligation. If, however, he performs chalitzah with the sisters, the other wives are not freed of their obligations until they themselves perform chalitzah. [The rationale is that] the chalitzah performed by the sisters is not "superior," and, as we have explained, a chalitzah that is not "superior" does not free another wife [of the deceased] from her obligation.

Halachah IO

יֵרָאֶה לִי שֶׁכָּךְ הַדִּין בִּשְׁתֵּי יְבָמוֹת הַבָּאוֹת מִבַּיִת אֶחָד וְהָאַחַת מֵהֶן אֲסוּרָה עַל יְבָמָהּ מִשּׁוּם שְׁנִיָּה אוֹ מֵחַיָּבֵי לָאוִין אוֹ מֵחַיָּבֵי עֲשֵׂה. שֶׁאִם חָלַץ לָאֲסוּרָה לֹא הֻתְּרָה צָרָתָהּ. חָלַץ לַצָּרָה הֻתְּרָה הָאֲסוּרָה׃

It appears to me that this law also applies with regard to two yevamot coming from one household, when one is forbidden to her yavam as a sh'niyah, or because of a positive or negative prohibition. If the yavam performs chalitzah with the woman who is prohibited, [the deceased's] other wife is not freed of her obligation. If he performs chalitzah with the other wife, the woman who is prohibited is freed of her obligation.

Halachah II

שְׁלֹשָׁה אַחִין שְׁנַיִם מֵהֶן נְשׂוּאִין שְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁי נָשׂוּי נָכְרִית. מֵת אֶחָד מִבַּעֲלֵי אֲחָיוֹת וְיִבֵּם הַנָּשׂוּי נָכְרִית אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ. וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵתָה אִשְׁתּוֹ שֶׁל שֵׁנִי וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵת הַשְּׁלִישִׁי וְנָפְלוּ שְׁתֵּי נָשָׁיו לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁנִי (שֶׁאֵין לוֹ אִשָּׁה). הֲרֵי אֵלּוּ פְּטוּרוֹת מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם. הָאַחַת מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיְתָה אֲחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁמֵּת אָחִיו הָרִאשׁוֹן נֶאֱסְרָה עָלָיו לְעוֹלָם מִשּׁוּם אֵשֶׁת אָח כְּדִין אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה בְּעוֹלָמוֹ. וְהַנָּכְרִית מִשּׁוּם צָרָתָהּ׃

[There is no need for yibbum or chalitzah in the following situation:] There were three brothers. Two were married to two sisters, and the third was married to a woman who did not share a family connection with them. One of the brothers married to the sisters died [childless] and the brother married to the other woman performed yibbum with [the brother's] wife. Afterwards, the wife of the second brother, [i.e., the sister of the yevamah] died, and then the third brother [the one who performed yibbum, died childless]. Thus, his two wives fall before the second brother, who is [now] unmarried. These women are free of the obligation to perform either chalitzah or yibbum. One, the sister of [the yavam's deceased] wife [is forbidden], because she was the sister of his wife at the time his brother died. [At that time,] she became forbidden to him forever, as the wife of a brother who was not alive at the time of his [older] brother's [death]. The other woman [is forbidden],

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because she is the other wife [of her deceased husband].

Halachah 12

וְכֵן שְׁנֵי אַחִין נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת וּמֵת אֶחָד מֵהֶן. וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵתָה אִשְׁתּוֹ שֶׁל שֵׁנִי. הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה עוֹלָמִית הוֹאִיל וְנֶאֱסְרָה עָלָיו בְּשָׁעַת נְפִילָה. אֲבָל הַמְגָרֵשׁ אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ וְהֶחֱזִירָהּ וָמֵת הֲרֵי זוֹ מֻתֶּרֶת לַיָּבָם. וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁנֶּאֱסְרָה עָלָיו בְּחַיֵּי אָחִיו בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁגֵּרְשָׁהּ הֲרֵי חֲזָרָה לְהֶתֵּרָהּ וּכְשֶׁמֵּת אָחִיו בְּהֶתֵּרָהּ הָיְתָה עוֹמֶדֶת:

Similarly, when two brothers are married to two sisters and one of [the brothers] dies [childless], and then the wife of the other brother dies, [the wife of the first brother] remains forbidden [to the second brother] forever, since she was forbidden to him at the time [the obligation of yibbum first takes effect]. When, however, a man divorces his wife, remarries her and then dies [childless], she is permitted to the yavam. Although she was forbidden to him during his brother's lifetime at the time he divorced her, she became permitted [when he remarried her]. And at the time his brother died, she was permitted.

Halachah 13

קְטַנָּה שֶׁהִשִּׂיאָהּ אָבִיהָ וְגֵרְשָׁהּ בַּעְלָהּ וְהֶחֱזִירָהּ וּמֵת וַעֲדַיִן הִיא קְטַנָּה הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה לַיָּבָם מִפְּנֵי שֶׁגֵּרוּשֶׁיהָ גֵּרוּשִׁין גְּמוּרִין שֶׁהֲרֵי אָבִיהָ הִשִּׂיאָהּ. וְאֵין חֲזָרָתָהּ חֲזָרָה גְּמוּרָה שֶׁאֵין קִדּוּשֵׁי קְטַנָּה קִדּוּשִׁין גְּמוּרִין כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

[The following rules apply when] a girl below the age of majority was given in marriage by her father, and her husband divorced her, remarried her and then died [childless] while she was still below the age of majority. She is forbidden to her yavam, for the divorce was a fully binding divorce, since she was married off by her father. The remarriage, by contrast, is not fully binding, because the consecration of a minor is not a completely binding consecration, as explained.

Halachah 14

וְהוּא הַדִּין לִמְגָרֵשׁ פִּקֵּחַת וְנִתְחָרְשָׁה וְהֶחֱזִירָהּ וּמֵת וְהִנִּיחָהּ חֵרֶשֶׁת שֶׁהִיא אֲסוּרָה לַיָּבָם וְאֵינָהּ חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וְצָרַת קְטַנָּה זוֹ אוֹ חֵרֶשֶׁת זוֹ חוֹלֶצֶת אוֹ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וְאִם הֶחֱזִירָהּ כְּשֶׁהִיא קְטַנָּה אוֹ חֵרֶשֶׁת וְגָדְלָה אוֹ נִתְפַּקְּחָה אֶצְלוֹ וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵת הֲרֵי זוֹ מֻתֶּרֶת לִיבָמָהּ:

The same law applies when a man divorces a woman who is mentally competent, she becomes a deaf-mute, he remarries her and dies [childless] while she is a deaf-mute. She is forbidden to the yavam and should not perform either chalitzah or yibbum. Another woman married [to the deceased husband of] the minor or the deaf-mute may perform chalitzah, or yibbum. If [the deceased] remarried her while she was a minor or a deaf-mute, but she attained majority or regained her control of her faculties while married to him, and then he died [childless], she is permitted to her yavam.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Halachah 15

שְׁנֵי אַחִין נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת. הָיוּ שְׁתֵּיהֶן קְטַנּוֹת הָרְאוּיוֹת לְמָאֵן אוֹ חֵרְשׁוֹת וּמֵת אֶחָד מֵהֶן תֵּצֵא מִשּׁוּם אֲחוֹת אִשָּׁה וּפְטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם. הָיוּ אַחַת גְּדוֹלָה וְאַחַת קְטַנָּה וּמֵת בַּעַל הַקְּטַנָּה תֵּצֵא מִשּׁוּם אֲחוֹת אִשָּׁה וּפְטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם. מֵת בַּעַל הַגְּדוֹלָה מְלַמְּדִין הַקְּטַנָּה שֶׁתְּמָאֵן בְּבַעְלָהּ וְתִהְיֶה גְּדוֹלָה זוֹ מֻתֶּרֶת לִיבָמָהּ:

When two brothers were married to two sisters, who were both below the age of majority and fit to dissolve their marriages through mi'un, or they were deaf-mutes, and one [of the brothers] dies [childless], his wife is not obligated to perform either chalitzah or yibbum, because she is the sister [of the yavam's] wife. If one [of the sisters] was above the age of majority and one was below, and the husband of the younger one died [childless], his wife is not obligated to perform either chalitzah or yibbum, because she is the sister [of the yavam's] wife. If the husband of the older [sister] died [childless], we instruct the younger one to absolve [her marriage to] her husband through mi'un, allowing the older [sister] to perform yibbum.

Halachah 16

שְׁנֵי אַחִין חֵרְשִׁין נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת פִּקְחוֹת אוֹ חֵרְשׁוֹת. אוֹ אַחַת פִּקַּחַת וְאַחַת חֵרֶשֶׁת. וְכֵן שְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת חֵרְשׁוֹת נְשׂוּאוֹת לִשְׁנֵי אַחִים פִּקְחִין אוֹ חֵרְשִׁין אוֹ אֶחָד פִּקֵּחַ וְאֶחָד חֵרֵשׁ וּמֵת אֶחָד מֵהֶן. אִשְׁתּוֹ פְּטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם מִשּׁוּם אֲחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ. שֶׁהֲרֵי אֵין נְשׂוּאֵי אֶחָד מֵהֶן נְשׂוּאִין גְּמוּרִין:

[The following law applies when two brothers who are both deaf-mutes are married to two sisters, and one [of the brothers] dies [childless]. His wife is not obligated to perform either chalitzah or yibbum, because she is the sister [of the yavam's] wife. [This law applies] regardless of whether both of the sisters were deaf-mutes, both were mentally competent, or one was a deaf-mute and one was mentally competent. Similarly, [the same law applies when] two sisters are both deaf-mutes and are married to two brothers, regardless of whether both of the brothers were deaf-mutes, both were mentally competent, or one was a deaf-mute and one was mentally competent. [These rulings were given] because none of the marriages is fully binding.

Halachah 17

שְׁנֵי אַחִין אֶחָד פִּקֵּחַ וְאֶחָד חֵרֵשׁ נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת פִּקְחוֹת אוֹ אַחַת פִּקַּחַת וְאַחַת חֵרֶשֶׁת וַהֲרֵי הַפִּקֵּחַת הִיא אֵשֶׁת הַפִּקֵּחַ. מֵת הַחֵרֵשׁ תֵּצֵא אִשְׁתּוֹ מִשּׁוּם אֲחוֹת אִשָּׁה. מֵת הַפִּקֵּחַ הוֹאִיל וְנִשּׂוּאֵי הַפִּקֵּחַ שֶׁמֵּת נְשׂוּאִין גְּמוּרִין וְזִקַּת זֶה הַחֵרֵשׁ גְּמוּרָה וְנִשּׂוּאֵי הַחֵרֵשׁ אֵינָן נְשׂוּאִין גְּמוּרִין. הֲרֵי זֶה הַחֵרֵשׁ מוֹצִיא אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ בְּגֵט מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֲחוֹתָהּ זְקוּקָה לוֹ. וְאֵשֶׁת אָחִיו הַפִּקֵּחַ אֲסוּרָה לְעוֹלָם שֶׁאֵינוֹ

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

What survives the mixture — nullification, the ark, and the words that outlast both.

Sunday, 11 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 6:9-6:22) · Daf Bekhorot 23

יָכוֹל לִכְנֹס מִפְּנֵי אֲחוֹתָהּ. וְלֹא יַחֲלֹץ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא חֵרֵשׁ:

[The following law applies when two brothers - one mentally competent and one a deaf-mute - are married to two sisters, either both mentally competent or one mentally competent and one a deaf-mute, and the mentally competent [sister] is married to the mentally competent [brother]. If the deaf-mute [brother] dies [childless], his wife is not obligated to perform either chalitzah or yibbum, because she is the sister [of the yavam's] wife. If the mentally competent [brother] dies [childless], the deaf-mute should divorce his wife with a get, because her sister is obligated to him. [The rationale for this ruling is] that the marriage of the deceased mentally competent brother was fully binding, [and thus] the obligation to the deaf-mute is also fully binding. [In contrast,] the marriage of the deaf-mute is not fully binding. The wife of the mentally competent brother is forbidden [to marry again] forever. For the deaf-mute cannot marry her because of her sister, nor can he perform chalitzah, because he is a deaf-mute.

Halachah 18

וְלָמָּה גָּזְרוּ חֲכָמִים שֶׁיּוֹצִיא זֶה הַחֵרֵשׁ אִשְׁתּוֹ הַחֵרֶשֶׁת וְהֵן אֵינָן בְּנֵי חִיּוּב אֶלָּא הֲרֵי הֵן כְּקָטָן אוֹכֵל נְבֵלוֹת שֶׁאֵין בֵּית דִּין מְצַוִּין לְהַפְרִישׁוֹ. אָמְרוּ חֲכָמִים אִם תֵּשֵׁב אִשְׁתּוֹ עִמּוֹ נִמְצֵאת אֲחוֹתָהּ נִשֵּׂאת לְזָר וְיֹאמְרוּ נִפְטְרָה מִשּׁוּם אֲחוֹת אִשָּׁה. לְפִיכָךְ מוֹצִיא הַחֵרֵשׁ אִשְׁתּוֹ בְּגֵט כְּדֵי שֶׁתִּהְיֶה אֲחוֹתָהּ אֲסוּרָה לְעוֹלָם:

Why did our Sages decree that a deaf-mute man must divorce his deaf-mute wife [in the above situation]? They are not obligated to observe the mitzvot; their situation resembles that of a child who eats non-kosher meat - in which instance, the court is not obligated to prevent them. Our Sages said: If the [deaf-mute's] wife will remain married to him, her sister will marry another man, [and this will be excused, for people] will say: "She was freed [from the obligations of yibbum and chalitzah] because she was the sister of [the yavam's] wife." [To prevent this impression from arising,] the deaf-mute must divorce his wife with a get, and her sister will be forbidden [to him] forever.

Halachah 19

וְכֵן שְׁנֵי אַחִין פִּקְחִין נְשׂוּאִין לִשְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת אַחַת פִּקַּחַת וְאַחַת חֵרֶשֶׁת. מֵת בַּעַל הַחֵרֶשֶׁת תֵּצֵא מִשּׁוּם אֲחוֹת אִשָּׁה. מֵת בַּעַל הַפִּקַּחַת מוֹצִיא אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ הַחֵרֶשֶׁת בְּגֵט וְאֶת אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו בַּחֲלִיצָה. מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא פִּקֵּחַ וְיָכוֹל לַחֲלֹץ:

Similarly, when two brothers who are mentally competent are married to two sisters, one mentally competent and one a deaf-mute, and the husband of the deaf-mute dies, [his wife] is free [of the obligation of yibbum], because she is the sister of [the yavam's] wife. If the husband of the mentally competent [sister] dies, [his brother] should divorce his wife [the deaf-mute] with a get, and should perform chalitzah to free the wife of his [deceased]

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

brother [to marry]. Since he is mentally competent, he can perform chalitzah.

Halachah 20

שְׁנֵי אַחִין אֶחָד פִּקֵּחַ וְאֶחָד חֵרֵשׁ. הַחֵרֵשׁ נָשׂוּי שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים פִּקְחוֹת הָאַחַת מֻתֶּרֶת עַל הַפִּקֵּחַ וּמֵת הַחֵרֵשׁ שְׁתֵּיהֶן פְּטוּרוֹת עַל כָּל פָּנִים. אִם נְשׂוּאֵי הָעֶרְוָה נְשׂוּאִין הֲרֵי הַשְּׁנִיָּה צָרָתָהּ וּפְטוּרָה. וְאִם אֵין נְשׂוּאֵי הָעֶרְוָה נְשׂוּאִין כָּךְ לֹא יִהְיוּ נְשׂוּאֵי צָרָתָהּ נְשׂוּאִין:

[Neither yibbum nor chalitzah is required in the following situation.] There were two brothers, one mentally competent and one a deaf-mute. The deaf-mute was married to two mentally competent women, one of whom was forbidden to the mentally competent brother as an ervah. If the deaf-mute brother dies [childless], both his wives are free from the obligations [of yibbum and chalitzah, based on the following rationale]. If the marriage of the woman forbidden [to the yavam] as an ervah is considered a marriage, the second woman is considered to be the other wife [of her husband] and is also freed of obligation. If the marriage of the woman forbidden [to the yavam] as an ervah is not considered a marriage, the marriage of the other woman is also not considered a marriage.

Halachah 21

הָיְתָה בִתּוֹ וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּהּ חֵרֶשֶׁת וּנְשׂוּאָה לְאָחִיו הַפִּקֵּחַ צָרָתָהּ חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. שֶׁאֵין נְשׂוּאֵי הַחֵרֶשֶׁת נְשׂוּאִין גְּמוּרִין:

If a man's daughter or the like was a deaf-mute, and she was married to his brother who was mentally competent [and the mentally competent brother dies childless], his other wife must perform chalitzah, but not yibbum. [The rationale is that] the marriage of the deaf-mute is not a fully binding marriage.

Halachah 22

כָּל מָקוֹם שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בַּהֲלָכוֹת אֵלּוּ שְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת אַחַת שְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת אוֹ אִשָּׁה וּבִתָּהּ אוֹ אִשָּׁה וּבַת בִּתָּהּ וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּהֶן עִנְיַן הַדְּבָרִים שֶׁהֵן שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים שֶׁהָאַחַת מֵהֶן עֶרְוָה עִם הָאַחֶרֶת וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לִשָּׂא שְׁתֵּיהֶן מִשּׁוּם עֶרְוָה. וְכֵן כָּל מָקוֹם שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ אֲחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ אוֹ אֲחוֹת יְבִמְתּוֹ אֶחָד אֲחוֹתָהּ אוֹ אִמָּהּ אוֹ בִתָּהּ עִנְיַן הַדְּבָרִים אַחַת מִקְרוֹבוֹתֶיהָ שֶׁהֵן עֶרְוָה עִמָּהּ:

Whenever we have mentioned "two sisters" in these laws, the intent is also a woman and her daughter, or her granddaughter and the like; i.e., two woman [for whom marriage to one causes] the other to be considered an ervah. Similarly, whenever we have mentioned "the sister of [the yavam's] wife" or "the sister of his yevamah," the intent is also her mother or her daughter - i.e., any close relative who becomes forbidden [to the yavam] because of her [marriage].

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

What survives the mixture — nullification, the ark, and the words that outlast both.

Sunday, 11 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 6:9-6:22) · Daf Bekhorot 23

Commentary

Chapter 7 is the Rambam's systematization of the Talmud's hardest yibbum knot: two brothers married to two sisters, both brothers dead. The surviving brother cannot perform yibbum with either — each is the sister of a woman bound to him by zikah — so both do chalitzah and neither does yibbum. The chapter's architecture is a controlled explosion of that core case: four brothers with cross-exemptions (hal. 2), sequential deaths where the second sister's death re-permits the first (hal. 3–4), ma'amar complicating the picture (hal. 6–7), a brother who consecrates his yevamah's sister and must wait (hal. 8), and multi-wife variants (hal. 9).

The commentators show their characteristic methods on this material. Migdal Oz is the source-tracer: on the opening ruling he simply notes 'it is all the chapter of Arba'ah Achin (Yevamot 30a–31a)' — the Talmudic address from which the Rambam quarried the whole structure. Ohr Sameach is the conceptual analyst: on halakhah 1 he works through the sugya at Yevamot 28b, asking why the Gemara's 'let her do yibbum, since by Torah law she is bound to him' does not carry the day, and locating the exact point where the rabbinic prohibition bites.

The chapter's gem is halakhah 10, where the Rambam breaks into the first person: 'יראה לי' — 'it appears to me.' He extends the two-sisters rule to two yevamot from one household where one is forbidden as a sh'niyah or by a positive or negative commandment: chalitzah with the forbidden one does not exempt her rival. Maggid Mishneh defends the chiddush at length, arguing from the logic of the sugya that the Rambam's extension is sound. It is a rare window into the Rambam reasoning aloud rather than ruling.

The chapter's second half (hal. 13–22) shifts register entirely: minors and deaf-mutes, whose marriages are rabbinic rather than Torah-level. Here the Rambam explains decrees — why the Sages ordered a deaf-mute to divorce his deaf-mute wife — with the famous analogy of a child eating non-kosher meat, whom the court need not restrain. The through-line of the whole chapter is the Rambam's instinct for grading obligation: Torah bond, rabbinic bond, no bond — and a precise procedure for each.

Maggid Mishneh as source-tracer (the Talmudic address of each ruling); Ohr Sameach as conceptual analyst of the sugya's logic; Migdal Oz mapping the chapter onto Yevamot's Arba'ah Achin.

GOV.IL ·

The state on firstborns

One government document this week — and it sits squarely in the tractate: the Chief Rabbinate's standing machinery for the sale that keeps firstborn sanctity from attaching at all.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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מתן הרשאה למכירת קנה וושט של בקר וצאן שעדיין לא המליטו

הרבנות הראשית לישראל

The Chief Rabbinate's authorization form for selling the windpipe and gullet of cattle and sheep before they give birth — the modern, centralized version of the gentile-partnership sale the daf's closing mishnah assumes (buying a nursing animal from a gentile). A gentile partner in the trachea and esophagus means no firstborn sanctity attaches, and the slaughterhouses will only accept animals from approved sellers.

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/service/permit-to-sell-the-firstborns-of-cattle-or-sheep/he/AuthorizationForm.pdf

NLI ·

From the National Library

No displayable image turned up in the National Library's catalogs for this week's terms — the ביטול search hit the library's own backend outage, and the בכור results were books and letters with no digitized pages. Worth noting in prose: the catalog holds 'ספר בכור קדשים,' halakhic discussions of the sale of firstborns that arose in Israel's agricultural sector — the twentieth-century afterlife of the very sale mechanism the daf's closing mishnah takes for granted.

דיונים הלכתיים שהתעוררו במשק החקלאי בארץ ישראל בענייני מכירת בכורות : ספר בכור קדשים
https://www.nli.org.il/en/books/NNL_ALEPH990027252090205171

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 1

Genesis 6:9-6:22

The week's first aliyah is the hinge of Parashat Noach: the verdict on the generation (6:9–13), the ark's blueprints (6:14–16), and the covenant promise with the cargo manifest (6:17–22). Read twice in Hebrew, once in Onkelos — and Onkelos, as always, is doing theology in translation.

אלקים

אלקים
18,278 attestations
first seen: בראשית ברא אלקים

Genesis 6:9 · ×2

אֵ֚לֶּה תּוֹלְדֹ֣ת נֹ֔חַ נֹ֖חַ אִ֣ישׁ צַדִּ֑יק תָּמִ֥ים הָיָ֖ה בְּדֹרֹתָ֑יו אֶת־הָאֱלֹקִ֖ים
הִתְהַלֶּךְ־נֹֽחַ׃
אֵ֚לֶּה תּוֹלְדֹ֣ת נֹ֔חַ נֹ֖חַ אִ֣ישׁ צַדִּ֑יק תָּמִ֥ים הָיָ֖ה בְּדֹרֹתָ֑יו אֶת־הָאֱלֹקִ֖ים
הִתְהַלֶּךְ־נֹֽחַ׃
אִלֵּין תּוֹלְדָת נֹחַ נֹחַ גְּבַר זַכַּאי שְׁלִים הֲוָה בְּדָרוֹהִי בְּדַחֲלְתָּא דַיְיָ֑ הַלִּיךְ נֹחַ׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT NOACH

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Genesis 6:10 · ×2

וַיּוֹלֶד נֹחַ שְׁלֹשָׁה בָנִים אֶת־שֵׁם אֶת־חָם וְאֶת־יָפֶת׃
וַיּוֹלֶד נֹחַ שְׁלֹשָׁה בָנִים אֶת־שֵׁם אֶת־חָם וְאֶת־יָפֶת׃
וְאוֹלִיד נֹחַ תְּלָתָא בְנִין יָת שֵׁם יָת חָם וְיָת יָפֶת׃

ארעא

Genesis 6:11 · ×2

וַתִּשָּׁחֵת הָאָרֶץ לִפְנֵי הָאֱלֹקִים וַתִּמָּלֵא הָאָרֶץ חָמָס׃
וַתִּשָּׁחֵת הָאָרֶץ לִפְנֵי הָאֱלֹקִים וַתִּמָּלֵא הָאָרֶץ חָמָס׃
וְאִתְחַבָּלַת אַרְעָא קֳדָם יְיָ וְאִתְמְלִיאַת אַרְעָא חֲטוֹפִין׃

כלבשר

בשר
12,709 attestations

from 'one flesh' to 'all flesh' condemned

בשרא

Genesis 6:12 · ×2

וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וְהִנֵּה נִשְׁחָתָה כִּי־הִשְׁחִית כָּל־בָּשָׂר אֶת־דַּרְכּוֹ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וְהִנֵּה נִשְׁחָתָה כִּי־הִשְׁחִית כָּל־בָּשָׂר אֶת־דַּרְכּוֹ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַחֲזָא יְיָ יָת אַרְעָא וְהָא אִתְחַבָּלַת אֲרֵי חַבִּילוּ כָּל בִּשְׂרָא אֱנָשׁ יָת אָרְחֵהּ עַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 6:13 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים לְנֹחַ קֵץ כָּל־בָּשָׂר בָּא לְפָנַי כִּי־מָלְאָה הָאָרֶץ חָמָס מִפְּנֵיהֶם וְהִנְנִי מַשְׁחִיתָם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים לְנֹחַ קֵץ כָּל־בָּשָׂר בָּא לְפָנַי כִּי־מָלְאָה הָאָרֶץ חָמָס מִפְּנֵיהֶם וְהִנְנִי מַשְׁחִיתָם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ לְנֹחַ קְצָא דְכָל בִּשְׂרָא עַלַת לְקֳדָמַי אֲרֵי אִתְמְלִיאַת אַרְעָא חֲטוֹפִין מִן קֳדָם עוֹבָדֵיהוֹן בִּישַׁיָּא וְהָא אֲנָא מְחַבֶּלְהוֹן עִם אַרְעָא׃

תעשה

עשה
73,885 attestations

the verb that makes the world — and the ark

Genesis 6:14 · ×2

עֲשֵׂה לְךָ֙ תֵּבַ֣ת עֲצֵי־גֹ֔פֶר קִנִּ֖ים תַּעֲשֶׂ֣ה אֶת־הַתֵּבָ֑ה וְכָפַרְתָּ֥ אֹתָ֛הּ מִבַּ֖יִת וּמִחֽוּץ׃ בַּכֹּֽפֶר׃
עֲשֵׂה לְךָ֙ תֵּבַ֣ת עֲצֵי־גֹ֔פֶר קִנִּ֖ים תַּעֲשֶׂ֣ה אֶת־הַתֵּבָ֑ה וְכָפַרְתָּ֥ אֹתָ֛הּ מִבַּ֖יִת וּמִחֽוּץ׃ בַּכֹּֽפֶר׃
עְבֵד לָךְ תֵּבוּתָא דְאָעִין דְקַדְרוֹם מְדוֹרִין תַּעְבֵּד יָת תֵּבוּתָא וְתֶחְפֵּי יָתַהּ מִגָּוָּ וּמִבָּרָא בְּכָפְרָא׃

Genesis 6:15 · ×2

וְזֶ֕ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר תַּעֲשֶׂ֖ה אֹתָ֑הּ שְׁלֹ֣שׁ מֵא֣וֹת אַמָּ֔ה אֹ֖רֶךְ הַתֵּבָ֑ה חֲמִשִּׁ֤ים אַמָּה֙ רָחְבָּ֔הּ וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים אַמָּ֖ה קוֹמָתָֽהּ׃
וְזֶ֕ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר תַּעֲשֶׂ֖ה אֹתָ֑הּ שְׁלֹ֣שׁ מֵא֣וֹת אַמָּ֔ה אֹ֖רֶךְ הַתֵּבָ֑ה חֲמִשִּׁ֤ים אַמָּה֙ רָחְבָּ֔הּ וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים אַמָּ֖ה קוֹמָתָֽהּ׃
וְדֵין דְתַעְבֵּד יָתַהּ תְּלָת מְאָה אַמִּין אוּרְכָּא דְתֵבוּתָא חַמְשִׁין אַמִּין פְּתָיֵהּ וּתְלָתִין אַמִּין רוּמַהּ׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT NOACH

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Genesis 6:16 · ×2

צֹהַר | תַּעֲשֶׂה לַתֵּבָה וְאֶל־אַמָּה תְּכַלֶּנָּה מִלְמַעְלָה וּפֶתַח הַתֵּבָה בְּצִדָּהּ תָּשִׂים תַּחְתִּיִּם שְׁנִיִּם וּשְׁלִשִׁים תְּעֲשֶׂהָ׃

צֹהַר | תַּעֲשֶׂה לַתֵּבָה וְאֶל־אַמָּה תְּכַלֶּנָּה מִלְמַעְלָה וּפֶתַח הַתֵּבָה בְּצִדָּהּ תָּשִׂים תַּחְתִּיִּם שְׁנִיִּם וּשְׁלִשִׁים תְּעֲשֶׂהָ׃

נֵהוֹר תַּעְבֵּיד לְתֵבוּתָא וּלְאַמְתָא תְּשַׁכְלְלִנַּהּ מִלְעֵלָּא וְתַרְעָא דְתֵבוּתָא בְּסִטְרַהּ תְּשַׁוֵּי מְדוֹרִין אַרְעִין תְּנָנִין וּתְלִיתָאִין תַּעְבְּדִנַּהּ׃

Genesis 6:17 · ×2

וַאֲנִי הִנְנִי מֵבִיא אֶת־הַמַּבּוּל מַיִם עַל־הָאָרֶץ לְשַׁחֵת כָּל־בָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ רוּחַ חַיִּים מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמָיִם כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־בָּאָרֶץ יִגְוָע׃

וַאֲנִי הִנְנִי מֵבִיא אֶת־הַמַּבּוּל מַיִם עַל־הָאָרֶץ לְשַׁחֵת כָּל־בָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ רוּחַ חַיִּים מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמָיִם כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־בָּאָרֶץ יִגְוָע׃

וַאֲנָא הָא אֲנָא מַיְתֵי יָת טוֹפָנָא מַיָּא עַל אַרְעָא לְחַבָּלָא כָּל בִּשְׂרָא דִּי בֵיהּ רוּחָא דְחַיֵּי מִתְּחוֹת שְׁמַיָּא כֹּל דִּי בְאַרְעָא יְמוּת׃

Genesis 6:18 · ×2

וַהֲקִמֹתִי אֶת־בְּרִיתִי אִתָּךְ וּבָאתָ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה אַתָּה וּבָנֶיךָ וְאִשְׁתְּךָ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנֶיךָ אִתָּךְ׃

וַהֲקִמֹתִי אֶת־בְּרִיתִי אִתָּךְ וּבָאתָ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה אַתָּה וּבָנֶיךָ וְאִשְׁתְּךָ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנֶיךָ אִתָּךְ׃

וְאָקֵם יָת קְיָמִי עִמָּךְ וְתֵעוֹל לְתֵבוּתָא אַתְּ וּבְנָךְ וְאִתְּתָךְ וּנְשֵׁי בְנָךְ עִמָּךְ׃

Genesis 6:19 · ×2

וּמִכָּל־הָחַי מִכָּל־בָּשָׂר שְׁנַיִם מִכֹּל תָּבִיא אֶל־הַתֵּבָה לְהַחֲיֹת אִתָּךְ זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה יִהְיוּ׃

וּמִכָּל־הָחַי מִכָּל־בָּשָׂר שְׁנַיִם מִכֹּל תָּבִיא אֶל־הַתֵּבָה לְהַחֲיֹת אִתָּךְ זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה יִהְיוּ׃

וּמִכָּל דְּחַי מִכָּל בִּשְׂרָא תְּרֵין מִכֹּלָּא תָּעֵיל לְתֵבוּתָא לְקַיָּמָא עִמָּךְ דְּכַר וְנֻקְבָּא יְהוֹן׃

Genesis 6:20 · ×2

מֵהָעוֹף לְמִינֵהוּ וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ מִכֹּל רֶמֶשׂ הָאֲדָמָה לְמִינֵהוּ שְׁנַיִם מִכֹּל יָבֹאוּ אֵלֶיךָ לְהָחֲיוֹת׃

מֵהָעוֹף לְמִינֵהוּ וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ מִכֹּל רֶמֶשׂ הָאֲדָמָה לְמִינֵהוּ שְׁנַיִם מִכֹּל יָבֹאוּ אֵלֶיךָ לְהָחֲיוֹת׃

מֵעוֹפָא לְזַנּוֹהִי וּמִן בְּעִירָא לְזַנָּהּ וּמִכֹּל רְחֵשָׁא דְאַרְעָא לְזַנּוֹהִי תְּרֵין מִכֹּלָּא יֵעֲלוּן לְוָתָךְ לְקַיָּמָא׃

Genesis 6:21 · ×2

וְאַתָּה קַח־לְךָ מִכָּל־מַאֲכָל אֲשֶׁר יֵאָכֵל וְאָסַפְתָּ אֵלֶיךָ וְהָיָה לְךָ וְלָהֶם לְאָכְלָה׃

וְאַתָּה קַח־לְךָ מִכָּל־מַאֲכָל אֲשֶׁר יֵאָכֵל וְאָסַפְתָּ אֵלֶיךָ וְהָיָה לְךָ וְלָהֶם לְאָכְלָה׃

וְאַתְּ סַב לָךְ מִכָּל מֵיכַל דְּמִתְאֲכֵל וְתִכְנוֹשׁ לְוָתָךְ וִיהֵי לָךְ וּלְהוֹן לְמֵיכַל׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 6:22 · ×2

וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֹתוֹ אֱלֹקִים כֵּן עָשָׂה׃
וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֹתוֹ אֱלֹקִים כֵּן עָשָׂה׃
וַעֲבַד נֹח כְּכֹל דִּי פַקֵּיד יְתֵיהּ יְיָ כֵּן עֲבָד׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 6:9

The verse mixes the divine names אלקים and הויה together — which, Shadal argues, collapses the claim that Moses stitched the story from separate ancient scrolls, each with its own divine name. And בדורותיו means he alone was righteous among all the people of those generations.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 6:9

'אלה תולדות' means 'these are the events' — like 'what the day will bring forth' (Prov. 27:1). צדיק describes his deeds, תמים his heart; and בדורותיו spans both his own generation and those after, since Noah lived until Abraham was fifty-eight.

Cassuto · Gen 6:9

Four possible parsings of 'איש צדיק תמים היה'; Cassuto prefers the fourth — Noah was a righteous man in the full sense, 'righteous to perfection.' On בדורותיו he notes the plural is difficult (7:1 has the singular בדור הזה) and rejects emending it away.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 6:9

תמים is not a second adjective but 'an adjective upon an adjective' (תואר על תאר) — it modifies צדיק itself, telling us Noah's righteousness was complete. The verse is not listing two virtues but grading one.

Netinah LaGer · Gen 6:9

Onkelos renders 'את האלקים התהלך נח' as 'בדחלתא דיי הליך נח' — in the fear of the Lord Noah walked — the standard anti-anthropomorphic buffer, cross-referenced to Onkelos's identical treatment of 'התהלכתי לפניו' (24:40) and 'התהלכו אבותי לפניו' (48:15).

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 6:9

בדחלתא דיי הליך נח אתהאלקים התהלךנח

The classic anti-anthropomorphic move: 'Noah walked with God' becomes 'Noah walked in the fear of the Lord.' Walking alongside the divine is unthinkable; walking in His fear is the

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pious equivalent. (Netinah LaGer flags this as the standard Onkelos treatment of the phrase.)

Gen 6:11

ואתחבלת ארעא קדם יי ותשחת הארץ לפני האלקים

'Before God' becomes 'before the Lord' via the קדם periphrasis — the corruption happens in front of Him, but the Aramaic buffer keeps the divine face at one remove from the rot.

Gen 6:11

ואתמליאת ארעא חטופין ותמלא הארץ חמס

חמס — 'violence,' a broad moral term — is narrowed to חטופין, 'robberies, seizures.' Onkelos legalizes the corruption: the generation's sin is specified as theft, the actionable crime rather than the atmosphere.

Gen 6:12

ארי חבילו כל בשרא אנש ית ארחה כיהשחית כלבשר אתדרכו

Onkelos inserts אנש — 'man' — into 'all flesh corrupted its way.' The specification is theological: animals do not sin. 'All flesh' is quietly restricted to humanity, the only flesh with a 'way' to corrupt.

Gen 6:14

עיבד לך תבותא דאעין דקדרום עשה לך תבת עציגפר

The unidentified גפר wood is identified as קדרום (cedar/cypress). Where the Hebrew leaves the species mysterious, Onkelos the translator refuses obscurity and names a timber — the etymologizing instinct.

Gen 6:14

מדורין תעבד ית תבותא קנים תעשה אתהתבה

קנים — 'nests,' an odd word for ship compartments — becomes מדורין, 'dwellings, chambers.' Onkelos clarifies by function: whatever קנים are, they are rooms to live in.

Gen 6:16

נהור תעביד לתבותא צהר תעשה לתבה

The hapax צהר — window? light? roof? — is resolved to נהור, plain 'light.' Centuries of commentary would debate the צהר; Onkelos simply decides it means illumination.

Gen 6:18

ואקם ית קימי והקמתי אתבריתי

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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ברית is invariably קים in Onkelos — 'my covenant' as 'my established thing.' The Aramaic root קום stresses not the pact but its standing: what God raises up and keeps upright.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

All 26 of Rashi's comments on Genesis 6:9–22, from the praise due to the righteous ('the mention of the righteous shall be for a blessing') to the carpentry of the ark — including the famous dispute over בדורותיו, praise or blame, and the grammatical note that the hitpael serves past and future alike.

אלה תולדת נח נח איש צדיק.

הוֹאִיל וְהִזְכִּירוֹ סִפֵּר בְּשִׁבְחוֹ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר זֵכֶר צַדִּיק לִבְרָכָה (משלי י').

אלה תולדת נח נח איש צדיק *THESE ARE THE PROGENY OF NOAH:*

דָּבָר אַחֵר לְמֶדְךָ שֶׁעִקַּר תּוֹלְדוֹתֵיהֶם שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים מַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים:

NOAH WAS A RIGHTEOUS MAN — Since the text mentions him it sings his praise, in accordance with what is said, (Proverbs 10:7) "The mention of the righteous shall be for a blessing." Another explanation is:

since after stating "These are the progeny of Noah", it does not at once mention the names of his children but declares that he "was a righteous man", Scripture thereby teaches you that the real progeny of righteous people are their good deeds (Genesis Rabbah 30:6).

בדרותיו.

יֵשׁ מֵרַבּוֹתֵינוּ דּוֹרְשִׁים אוֹתוֹ לְשֶׁבַח,

בדורותיו *IN HIS GENERATIONS — Some of our Rabbis explain it (this word) to his credit:*

he was righteous even in his generation;

כָּל שֶׁכֵּן אִלּוּ הָיָה בְּדוֹר צַדִּיקִים הָיָה צַדִּיק יוֹתֵר; וְיֵשׁ שֶׁדּוֹרְשִׁים אוֹתוֹ לְגָנַאי,

it follows that had he lived in a generation of righteous people he would have been even more righteous owing to the force of good example.

Others, however, explain it to his discredit:

לְפִי דּוֹרוֹ הָיָה צַדִּיק וְאִלּוּ הָיָה בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם לֹא הָיָה נֶחְשָׁב לִכְלוּם (סנה' ק"ח):

in comparison with his own generation he was accounted righteous, but had he lived in the generation of Abraham he would have been accounted as of no importance (cf.

Sanhedrin 108a).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT NOACH

What survives the mixture — nullification, the ark, and the words that outlast both.

Sunday, 11 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 6:9-6:22) · Daf Bekhorot 23

את האלקים התהלך נח.

וּבְאַבְרָהָם הוּא אוֹמֵר אֲשֶׁר הִתְהַלַּכְתִּי לְפָנָיו? (בראׁ כ"ד), נֹחַ הָיָה צָרִיךְ סַעַד לְתָמְכוֹ,

את האלקים התהלך נח *NOAH WALKED WITH GOD — In the case of Abraham Scripture says, (Genesis 24:40) "[God] before whom I walked";*

אֲבָל אַבְרָהָם הָיָה מִתְחַזֵּק וּמְהַלֵּךְ בְּצִדְקוֹ מֵאֵלָיו:

Noah needed God's support to uphold him in righteousness, Abraham drew his moral strength from himself and walked in his righteousness by his own effort (Genesis Rabbah 30:10).

התהלך.

לְשׁוֹן עָבָר, וְזֶהוּ שְׁמוּשׁוֹ שֶׁל לָשׁוֹן,

בְּלָשׁוֹן כָּבֵד מְשַׁמֶּשֶׁת לְהַבָּא וּלְשֶׁעָבַר בְּלָשׁוֹן א', קוּם הִתְהַלֵּךְ (שם י"ג) לְהַבָּא, הִתְהַלֵּךְ נֹחַ לְשֶׁעָבַר;

התהלך *HE WALKED — This word is in the past tense.*

הִתְפַּלֵּל בְּעַד עֲבָדֶיךָ (שמואל א' י"ב) לְהַבָּא,

The following is the usage of this verbal form:

וּבָא וְהִתְפַּלֵּל אֶל הַבַּיִת הַזֶּה (מ"א ח') לְשׁוֹן עָבָר,

in the "heavy" (כבד) conjugation one grammatical form is used both as future (i. e. the imperative, since the imperative calls for on action to be done in the future relative to the time when the command is given) and as past tense e. g., (13:17) קום התהלך *"arise walk" is future (i. e. imperative);* התהלך נח *"Noah walked" (in this passage) is past;*

אֶלָּא שֶׁהַוָּי"ו שֶׁבְּרֹאשׁוֹ הֶפְכוֹ לְהַבָּא:

(1 Samuel 12:19) התפלל בעד עבדיך *"Pray for thy servants" is future (i. e. imperative) and (1 Kings 8:42)* ובא והתפלל אל הבית הזה *"When he shall come and shall pray toward this house" is past, only that the* ו *at the beginning of the word changes the tense into the future (it is Vav conversive).*

ותשחת.

לְשׁוֹן עֶרְוָה וַעֲ"ז (סנה' נ"ז) כְּמוֹ פֶּן תַּשְׁחִתוּן (דב' ד'), כִּי הִשְׁחִית כָּל בָּשָׂר וְגוֹ':

ותשחת *[THE EARTH] WAS CORRUPT — It means lewdness and idolatry, as (Deuteronomy 4:16)* פן תשחיתון *"lest ye deal corruptly" (the following words show that this refers to idolatry) and as* וגו' כי השחית כל בשר *"for all flesh had corrupted etc." (in next verse of this chapter where Rashi states that this has reference to lewdness) (Sanhedrin 57a).*

ותמלא הארץ חמס.

גֵּזֶל:

ותמלא הארץ חמס *AND THE EARTH WAS FILLED WITH VIOLENCE — means robbery.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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כי השחית כל בשר.

אֲפִלּוּ בְּהֵמָה חַיָּה וְעוֹף נִזְקָקִין לְשֶׁאֵינָן מִינָן:

כי השחית כל בשר *FOR ALL FLESH HAD CORRUPTED — even cattle, beasts and fowl did not consort with their own species (Genesis Rabbah 28:8).*

קץ כל בשר.

כָּל מָקוֹם שֶׁאַתָּה מוֹצֵא זְנוּת וַעֲ"ז אַנְדְּרוֹלוֹמוּסְיָא בָּאָה לָעוֹלָם וְהוֹרֶגֶת טוֹבִים וְרָעִים.

קץ כל בשר *THE END OF ALL FLESH — Wherever you find lewdness and idolatry, punishment of an indiscriminate character comes upon the world killing good and bad alike (Genesis Rabbah 26:5).*

כי מלאה הארץ חמס.

לֹא נֶחְתַּם גְּזַר דִּינָם אֶלָּא עַל הַגֵּזֶל (סנה' ק"ח):

כי מלאה הארץ חמס *FOR THE EARTH IS FILLED WITH VIOLENCE — Their fate was sealed only on account of their sin of robbery (Sanhedrin 108a).*

את הארץ.

כְּמוֹ מִן הָאָרֶץ, וְדוֹמֶה לוֹ כְּצֵאתִי אֶת הָעִיר (שמ' ט'), מִן הָעִיר; חָלָה אֶת רַגְלָיו (מ"א ט"ו), מִן רַגְלָיו. דְּ"אַ אֶת הָאָרֶץ עִם הָאָרֶץ,

את הארץ *[I WILL DESTROY THEM] WITH THE EARTH — It is similar to* מן הארץ *"from the earth";*

other examples of this use of את *are:*

שֶׁאַף ג' טְפָחִים שֶׁל עֹמֶק הַמַּחֲרֵשָׁה נִמְחוּ וְנִטַּשְׁטְשׁוּ:

(Exodus 9:29) בצאתי *"when I go forth"* את העיר *which means* מן העיר *"from the city" and (1 Kings 15:23)* חלה *"he suffered"* את רגליו *which means* מן רגליו *"from his feet".*

Another explanation of את הארץ *is: "together with the earth" — for the earth was blotted out and washed away to the depth of a furrow of three handbreadths (Genesis Rabbah 31:7).*

עשה לך תבת.

הַרְבֵּה רֶוַח וְהַצָּלָה לְפָנָיו, וְלָמָּה הִטְרִיחוֹ בִּבְנְיָן זֶה?

עשה לך תבת *MAKE THEE AN ARK — There are numerous ways by which God could have saved Noah;*

כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּרְאוּהוּ אַנְשֵׁי דוֹר הַמַּבּוּל עוֹסֵק בָּהּ ק"כ שָׁנָה, וְשׁוֹאֲלִין אוֹתוֹ מַה זֹּאת לְךָ,

why, then, did he burden him with this construction of the Ark?

וְהוּא אוֹמֵר לָהֶם עָתִיד הַקָּבָ"ה לְהָבִיא מַבּוּל לָעוֹלָם, אוּלַי יָשׁוּבוּ:

So that the men of the generation of the Flood might see him employed on it for 120 years and might ask him, "What do you need this for"?

and so that he might answer them, "The Holy One, blessed be He, is about to bring a flood upon the world" — perhaps they might repent (literally, return to God) (Sanhedrin 108b).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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עצי גופר.

כָּךְ שְׁמוֹ. וְלָמָּה מִמִּין זֶה? עַל שֵׁם גֻּפְרִית שֶׁנִּגְזַר עֲלֵיהֶם לִמָּחוֹת בּוֹ:

עצי גופר *GOPHER WOOD — Thus is its name.*

Why of this species (גפר)?

Because of the (גפרית) "sulphur" by which it was decreed that they were to be blotted out.

קנים.

מְדוֹרִים מְדוֹרִים לְכָל בְּהֵמָה וְחַיָּה:

קנים *ROOMS — Separate cabins for each kind of cattle and beast.*

בכפר.

זֶפֶת בְּלָשׁוֹן אֲרַמִּי, וּמְצִינוּ בַּתַּלְמוּד כּוֹפְרָא בְּתֵבָתוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה,

בכפר *WITH* כפר *— This is an Aramaic term for the Hebrew* זפת *"pitch", and in the Talmud (Shabbat 67a) we find the noun* כופרא *"pitch".*

עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהָיוּ הַמַּיִם תָּשִׁים דַּיָּהּ בְּחֹמֶר מִבִּפְנִים וְזֶפֶת מִבַּחוּץ; וְעוֹד,

In the case of the ark (cradle) in which Moses was placed, since the waters were not rapid it sufficed that it should be daubed with slime inside and with pitch outside;

כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יָרִיחַ אוֹתוֹ צַדִּיק רֵיחַ רַע שֶׁל זֶפֶת,

and a further reason for this was that this righteous person (Moses) should not smell the bad odour of the pitch (Sotah 12a).

אֲבָל כָּאן מִפְּנֵי חֹזֶק הַמַּיִם זְפָתָהּ מִבַּיִת וּמִחוּץ:

Here, however, because of the rough waters he had to cover it with pitch inside as well as outside.

צהר.

יֵ"שׁ חַלּוֹן וְיֵ"שׁ אֶבֶן טוֹבָה הַמְּאִירָה לָהֶם (ב"ר שם):

צהר *A LIGHT — Some say this was a window;*

others say that it was a precious stone that gave light to them (Genesis Rabbah 31:11).

ואל אמה תכלנה מלמעלה.

כְּסוּיָהּ מְשֻׁפָּע וְעוֹלֶה עַד שֶׁהוּא קָצָר מִלְּמַעְלָה וְעוֹמֵד עַל אַמָּה כְּדֵי שֶׁיְּזוּבוּ הַמַּיִם לְמַטָּה מִכָּאן וּמִכָּאן:

ואל אמה תכלנה מלמעלה *AND TO A CUBIT SHALT THOU FINISH IT UPWARD — Its covering (roof) slanted upwards so that it narrowed at the top to a cubit, in order that the water should run off on both sides.*

בצדה תשים.

שֶׁלֹּא יִפְּלוּ הַגְּשָׁמִים בָּהּ:

בצדה תשים *THOU SHALT SET [THE DOOR] IN THE SIDE THEREOF — in order that the rain might not penetrate.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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תחתים שנים ושלשים.

ג' עֶלְיוֹת זוֹ עַל גַּב זוֹ, עֶלְיוֹנִים לָאָדָם, אֶמְצָעִים לְמָדוֹר, תַּחְתִּיִּים לִזֶּבֶל (שם):

תחתים שנים ושלישים *WITH LOWER, SECOND AND THIRD STORIES — Three stories one above the other:*

the top rooms for the human beings, the middle ones as cabins for the cattle, and the bottom was for the refuse (Sanhedrin 108b).

ואני הנני מביא.

הִנְנִי מוּכָן לְהַסְכִּים עִם אוֹתָם שֶׁזֵּרְזוּנִי וְאָמְרוּ לְפָנַי כְּבָר מָה אֱנוֹשׁ כִּי תִזְכְּרֶנּוּ (תה' ח'):

ואני הנני מביא *AND I, BEHOLD, I DO BRING — God says, "Now I am prepared to agree with those angels who cautioned Me and long ago said to Me (when I was about to create man), (Psalms 8:5) "What is man that thou art mindful of him" (Genesis Rabbah 31:12).*

מבול.

שֶׁבִּלְּהָ אֶת הַכֹּל, שֶׁבִּלְבֵּל אֶת הַכֹּל,

מבול *A FLOOD — so called because it ruined (בלה) everything;*

שֶׁהוֹבִיל אֶת הַכֹּל מִן הַגְּבוֹהַ לַנָּמוּךְ;

because it cast everything into confusion (בלל), and because it brought (הוביל from root יבל) everything down from the heights to a lower level.

And this last explanation underlies the translation of Onkelos who translates it by טופנא (Ar. טוף = Heb. צוף) because the Flood caused everything to float about and brought it (the Ark) to Babel which is a low-lying district.

וְזֶהוּ לְשׁוֹן אֲנְקְלוֹס שֶׁתִּרְגֵּם טוֹפָנָא, שֶׁהֵצִיף אֶת הַכֹּל, וְהֶבִיאָהּ לְבָבֶל שֶׁהִיא עֲמֻקָּה, לְכָךְ נִקְרֵאת שִׁנְעָר, שֶׁנִּנְעֲרוּ שָׁם כָּל מֵתֵי מַבּוּל:

That is the reason why it (Babylon) is called, also, Shinar (שנער):

because all those who died through the Flood were shaken out (ננערו) into it (Shabbat 113b).

והקמתי את בריתי.

בְּרִית הָיְתָה צְרִיכָה עַל הַפֵּרוֹת שֶׁלֹּא יִרָקְבוּ וְיִעָפְּשׁוּ וְשֶׁלֹּא יַהַרְגוּהוּ רְשָׁעִים שֶׁבַּדּוֹר (ב"ר):

והקמתי את בריתי *BUT I WILL ESTABLISH MY COVENANT — A covenant was necessary for the sake of the fruits that they should not rot or decay;*

and also that the wicked people of that generation should not kill him (Genesis Rabbah 31:12)

אתה ובניך ואשתך.

הָאֲנָשִׁים לְבַד וְהַנָּשִׁים לְבַד; מִכָּאן שֶׁנֶּאֶסְרוּ בְּתַשְׁמִישׁ הַמִּטָּה: (שם):

אתה ובניך ואשתך *THOU, AND THY SONS AND THY WIFE — Males separately and females separately.*

From this one may infer that they were not permitted to live together in the Ark as man and wife (Sanhedrin 108b).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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ומכל החי.
אֲפִלּוּ שֵׁדִים (ב"ר):

ומכל החי *AND OF EVERY LIVING THING — Even of demons (Genesis Rabbah 31:13).*

שנים מכל.
מִן הַפְּחוּת שֶׁבָּהֶם לֹא פָּחוֹת מִשְּׁנַיִם, אֶחָד זָכָר וְאֶחָד נְקֵבָה:

שנים מכל *TWO OF EVERY SORT — Even of the least numerous amongst them there were not less than two—one male, the other female.*

מהעוף למינהו.
אוֹתָן שֶׁדָּבְקוּ בְּמִינֵיהֶם וְלֹא הִשְׁחִיתוּ דַּרְכָּם, וּמֵאֵלֵּיהֶם בָּאוּ,

מהעוף למינהו *OF THE FOWLS AFTER THEIR KIND— those that had kept to their own species and had not corrupted their way (taking the words to mean, “of the fowls that had kept to their own kind”).*

וְכֹל שֶׁהַתֵּבָה קוֹלַטְתּוּ הִכְנִיס (ב"ר):

All these came of their own accord, but only those which the Ark was allowing to pass in did Noah permit to enter (Sanhedrin 108b).

ויעש נח.
זֶה בִּנְיַן הַתֵּבָה:

ויעש נח *THUS DID NOAH — This refers to the building of the Ark (Genesis Rabbah 31:14).*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Four comments, one sugya

All four of Rashi's source-richest comments on this aliyah cluster on a single verse — 6:9 — and a single sugya, Sanhedrin 108a. The most revealing is בדרתיו: 'מרבותינו דורשים אותו לשבח ...יש שדורשים אותו לגנאי.' Rashi compresses the Talmud's full dispute — Rabbi Yochanan reading בדורותיו as praise ('all the more so had he lived among the righteous'), Resh Lakish as blame ('in his generation he was righteous; in Abraham's he would have counted for nothing') — into two balanced clauses. It is unattributed compression at its tightest: no names, no 'אמר,' just the dispute's skeleton.

The opening comment shows Rashi's other mode, the anthological pivot: 'והזכירו סיפר בשבחו תולדותיהם של צדיקים מעשים טובים' — 'דבר אחר' (from 'זכר צדיק לברכה,' Prov. 10:7), then 'האילקים התהלך נח עיקר,' the midrashic reading that turns 'progeny' into 'good deeds.' And on 'את' Rashi stages an explicit aggadic contrast with Abraham ('אשר התהלכתי לפניו'): Noah needed support to walk; Abraham strode on his own. The verse's grammar becomes biography.

WORD STUDIES

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Three words from the aliyah

Three Hebrew words from Genesis 6:9–22, each swept through the Historical Dictionary's citations — earliest attestations to latest, with the clusters that reveal the journey. (Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria: the Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon at cal.huc.edu prohibits scraping, so its data cannot be included.)

עָשָׂה

BDB · עשה

— I. עשה vb. do, make (NH = BH; MI23.26 עשתי, l.3.9 ואעש, l.24 Imv. עשו; OH n.pr. מעשיהו, אלעשה, עשיו; not Aramaic, and not certainly found in S. Sem. lang.; on Sab. v. especially DHMSB Berl. Akkadian 1886, 849);—

BDB · עשה²

Maagarim

עשי [קל] — 73885 attestations, root עשי 1 (עשייה).

תעשה — the verb עשה, 73,885 attestations across a staggering 2,829 citation pages. It is first seen doing the heaviest work in the language: 'ויעש אלקים את הרקיע' (Gen. 1:7), the verb of creation itself, repeated through the six days as God makes lights, beasts, and man. In our aliyah the same verb descends from heaven to the shipyard: 'עשה לך תבת עציגפר' — make yourself an ark. Divine creation becomes human construction under divine command, and the verb does not change. It lands, twenty-nine centuries later, in Yitzhak Shami's 1937 novel — 'רגע עשתה נסיון נואש,' a desperate attempt — still the plain workhorse verb, still making. BDB's gloss is almost laconic: 'do, make.' The sweep shows why: no word that made the firmament needs ornament.

אֱלֹקִים

Jastrow · אלקים

— , v. אלוה

Klein · אלקים

m.n. pl.

— God (pl. of majesty).

BDB · אלקים

— n.m.pl. (f. 1 K 11:33; on number of occurrences of אל, אלוה, אלקים cf. also Nesl.c.)

Maagarim

אלקים — 18278 attestations, root אלה 1 (אל).

אלקים — 18,278 attestations, 775 pages, and the first citation is the Bible's first verse: 'אלקים בראשית ברא.' The divine name enters the language creating. In our aliyah Noah 'walks with' that name — 'אתהאלקים התהלכנח' — the plural-of-majesty that Klein glosses simply as 'God.' The sweep's striking turn comes at the very tail: in Shami's 1937 'ומעה אלאהבל'ג,' set among Arab villagers, אלקים renders the Islamic divine name — 'ירחמהו אלקים,' may God have mercy

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

What survives the mixture — nullification, the ark, and the words that outlast both.

Sunday, 11 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 6:9-6:22) · Daf Bekhorot 23

on him; 'כליל אלה,' friend of God. The name that opened Genesis proves portable enough to name another tradition's God. From the Creator of Genesis 1 to the God of a Galilean village tale — the word's majesty turns out to be its universality.

כלבשר

Maagarim

בשר (כלבשר: written form, 1 occurrence) — 12709 attestations, root בשר 2 (בשר הגוף).

כלבשר — strictly the בשר entry (כלבשר itself occurs once as a written form): 12,709 attestations of the 'flesh' root בשר 2, distinct from the 'tidings' root בשר 1. First seen in the garden's intimacy: 'ויסגר בשר תחתנה' (Gen. 2:21), 'עצם מעצמי ובשר מבשרי,' 'והיו לבשר אחד' — flesh as kinship, the body joined. In our aliyah the compound כלבשר is the condemned totality: 'קץ כלבשר בא לפני.' The same flesh that meant union in Eden means the whole doomed order here — Onkelos even narrows it, inserting 'man,' as if to insist the animals are not the point. Jastrow's second sense, 'mortal,' already hears the mortality inside the meat.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr